- *A* persistent block-level storage *volume connected via network*—This is the best choice for most problems, because it is independent of your virtual machine's life cycle and replicates data among multiple disks automatically to increase durability and availability.
- *A* temporary block-level storage *volume physically attached to the host system of the virtual machine*—This is interesting if you're optimizing for performance, because it is directly attached to the host system and, therefore, offers low latency and high throughput when accessing your data.

The next three sections will introduce and compare these two solutions by connecting storage with an EC2 instance, doing performance tests, and exploring how to back up the data.

8.1 Elastic Block Store (EBS): Persistent block-level storage attached over the network

Elastic Block Store (EBS) provides persistent block-level storage with built-in data replication. Typically, EBS is used in the following scenarios:

- Operating a relational database system on a virtual machine
- Running a (legacy) application that requires a filesystem to store data on EC2
- Storing and booting the operating system of a virtual machine